

PPHA 38520-1 Final Project Rubric | Spring 2026

The final project consists of 250 points. The presentation is an oral report to the class on May 18, worth 50 points. The final project report is a written paper of about 4 to 8 pages (not to exceed 15 pages, exclusive of figures), worth 200 pages, due May 27. For most research questions, a report should include a clearly stated thesis; a hypothesis; some review of at least 2 or 3 similar studies in existing literature (at least use Google Scholar to find related work); an explanation of appropriate and logical methods for conducting a study and/or developing innovative maps; some analysis of the findings; and a conclusion. Some projects are more applied, however, and will not look like a standard scientific paper. They should instead focus on describing and contextualizing a real-world problem, outlining the methods, and reflecting on the experience and limitations in a discussion section. The specific breakdown for grading that final report is as follows:

Category	Excellent (40 points)	Proficient (30 points)	Satisfactory (20 points)	Needs Improvement (10 points)	Not Attempted (0 points)
<i>Thesis & Hypotheses, or Problem Statement</i>	Clearly articulated and logical	Clearly articulated with only minor issues	Stated, but with some logical issues or unclear premise	Vague or unclear	No thesis or hypotheses stated
<i>Literature Review or Background</i>	Thorough, well-contextualized	Reasonably explained	Somewhat adequate, limited context	Poorly contextualized, misleading representations	No literature review or background about the study
<i>Application of GIS Methods & Data</i>	Highly suitable based on literature, or innovative	Suitable methodology and overall approach	Acceptable, but lacking details, or some data issues	Unsuitable or inappropriate methods or data approach	No GIS methodology presented
<i>Analysis & Maps, or Discussion</i>	Insightful and comprehensive analysis; at least 2 original maps presented	Sound analysis but with some minor issues; 2 original maps provided	Limited or somewhat flawed analysis; 1 map presented	Inadequate or unclear analysis; 1 map presented	No analysis or discussion of results
<i>Conclusion or Findings</i>	Clear and compelling conclusions/findings explained in detail	Clear conclusions/findings	Findings stated, with minor ambiguities	Vague or unclear conclusions/findings	No conclusions or findings presented